
Which Southeast Asian market first?

Market-entry recommendation for a language-learning app. The company is hypothetical; every market statistic is public World Bank data, cited on each slide.

Head of Growth (hypothetical company) · October 2026

Launch in Indonesia first, and let a six-week paid test confirm it before full spend

1 **Indonesia is the largest reachable market**

206M internet users in 2024, 2.4 times Vietnam's and over 3 times Thailand's.

2 **It stays largest after adjusting for income**

Internet users times income per person (PPP) puts Indonesia at least twice any other candidate.

3 **Vietnam is the best backup**

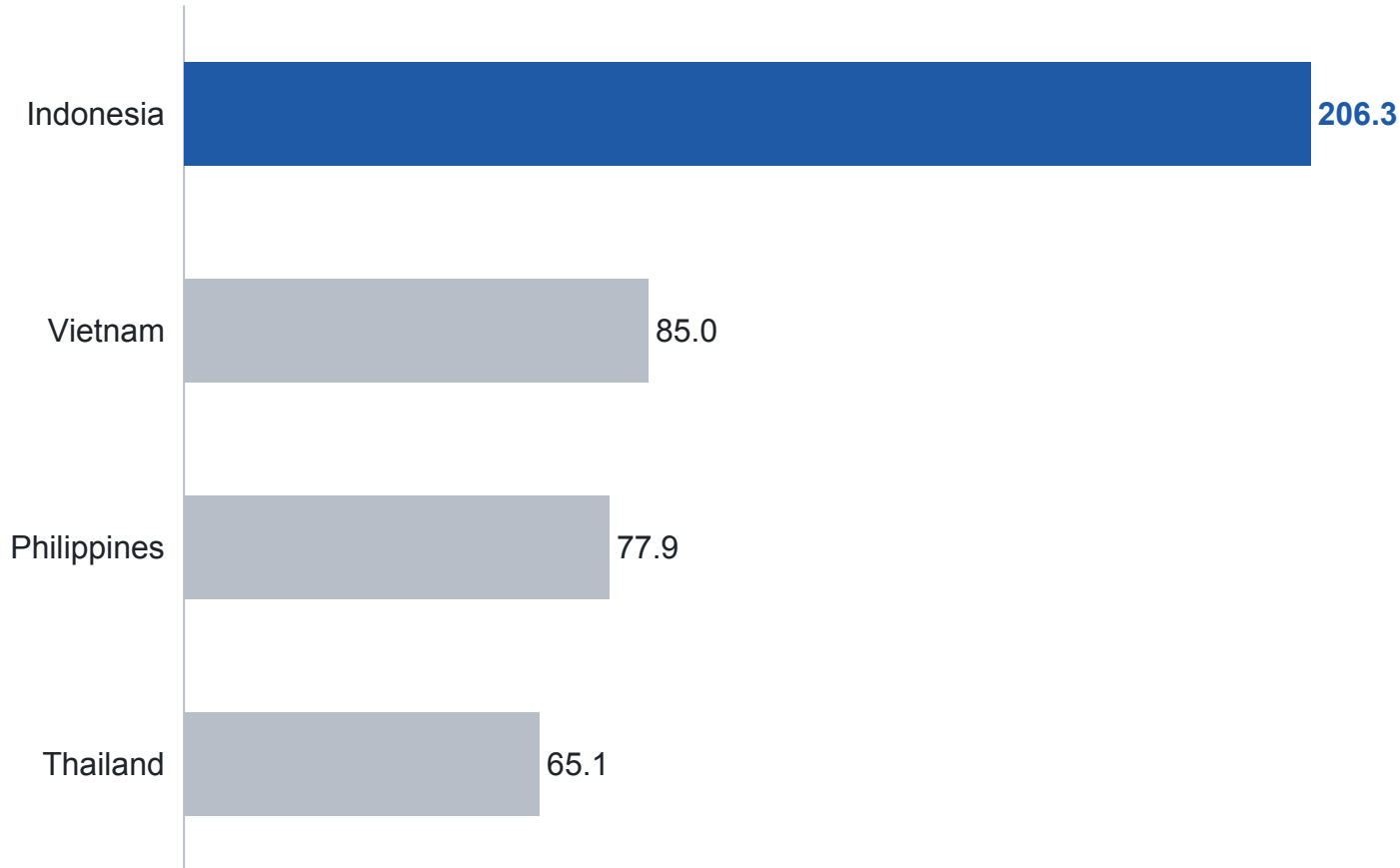
The fastest-growing economy of the four, but its online audience is 41% of Indonesia's.

4 **Whether we can win is still unknown**

Public statistics do not show willingness to pay, competition or acquisition cost; a six-week paid test does.

Indonesia has 206M internet users, 2.4 times Vietnam's and over 3 times Thailand's

Internet users, 2024, millions

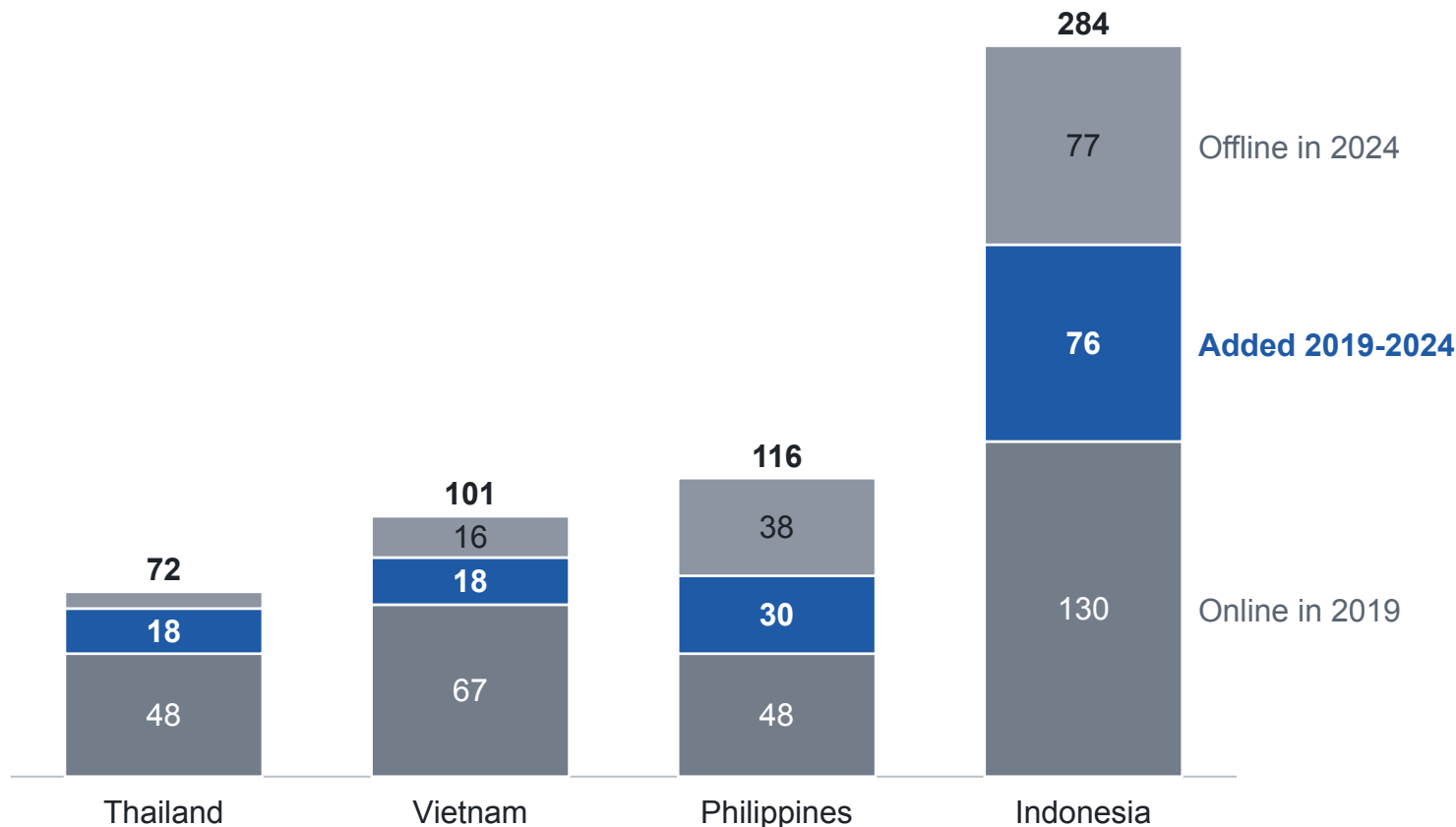


So what

- Indonesia has more internet users than Vietnam and Thailand combined (150M)
- For a mobile app, internet users are the audience we can reach

Indonesia also added the most users since 2019 (+76M) and still has 77M people offline

Population by internet use, millions

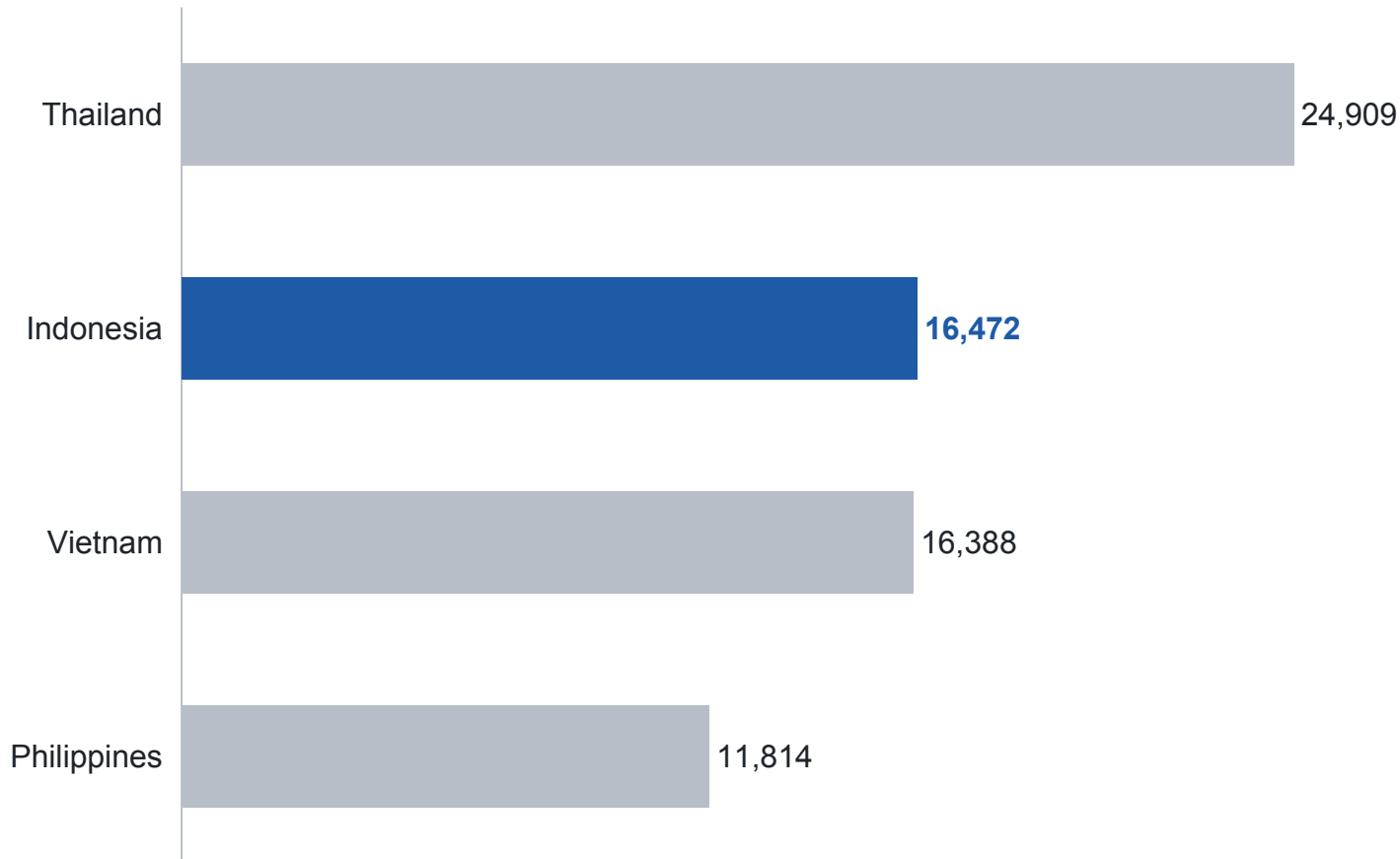


So what

- Indonesia added more users in five years (76M) than Thailand has in total (65M)
- Vietnam and Thailand are already mostly online, so they have less room to add users

Income per person in Indonesia matches Vietnam's and trails only Thailand's

GDP per capita, PPP, 2024, current international \$

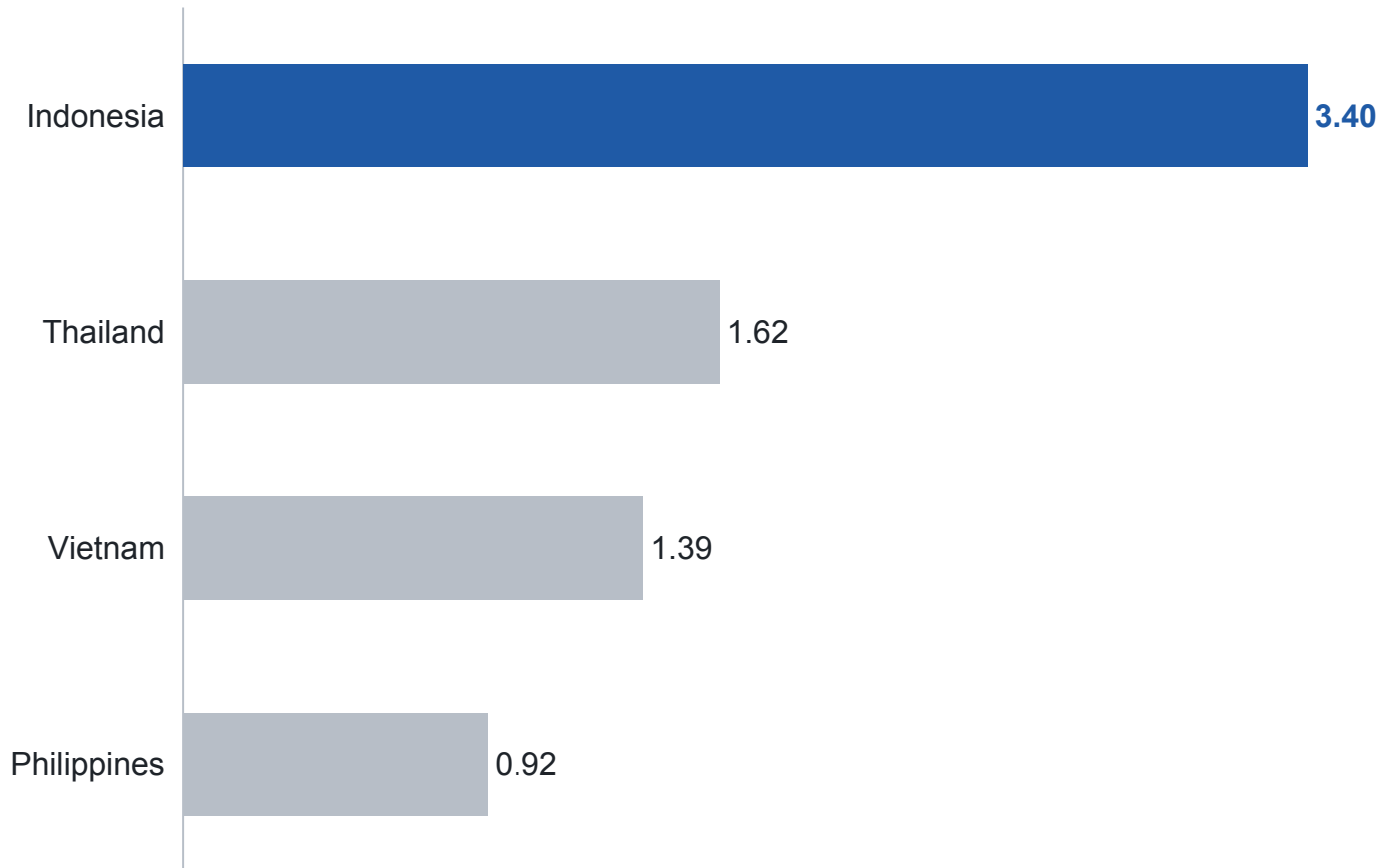


So what

- Indonesia and Vietnam are within 1% of each other
- In 2025 Vietnam edges ahead (18,088 vs 17,660); the two remain close
- The Philippines has the lowest income of the four

Adjusted for income, Indonesia's online market is at least twice that of any other candidate

Internet users x GDP per capita (PPP), 2024, international \$ trillion

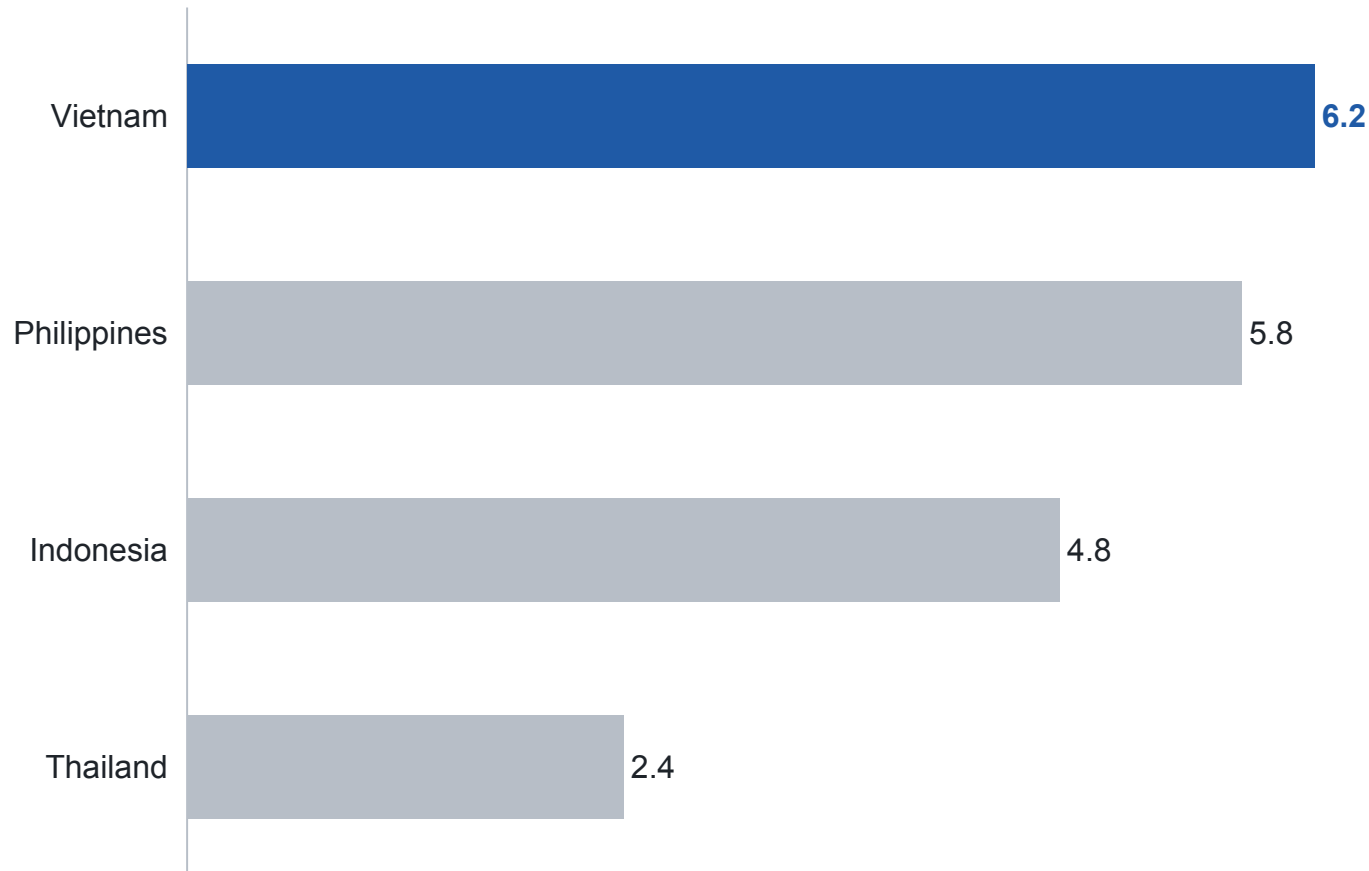


So what

- 2.1 times Thailand, 2.4 times Vietnam, 3.7 times the Philippines
- A rough proxy used only to rank markets, not to size revenue

Vietnam is the best backup: the fastest-growing economy, but under half Indonesia's online audience

Average real GDP growth, 2021-2025, %



So what

- Vietnam also grew fastest in 2025: 8.0%, against 5.1% for Indonesia
- Its income per person (PPP) rose 64% from 2019 to 2025, the most of the four
- But its 85M internet users are 41% of Indonesia's, so it is the backup, not the first launch

Thailand is small and slow-growing, and the Philippines has the lowest income of the four

Thailand

- Fewest internet users: 65.1M in 2024
- Slowest economy: 2.4% average growth in 2021-2025
- Highest income per person: \$24,909 (PPP, 2024)
- 91% already online, so little room for new users

Philippines

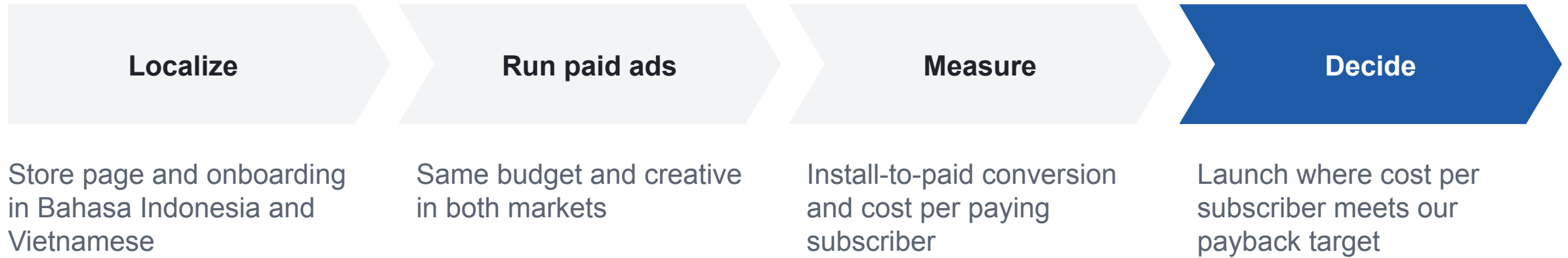
- Lowest income per person: \$11,814 (PPP, 2024)
- 77.9M internet users in 2024, after a break in the series (appendix)
- Solid growth: 5.8% average in 2021-2025
- Smallest market after adjusting for income: \$0.92T

We cannot yet say if we can win: app spending, competition and acquisition cost are unknown

Question	What public statistics show	What we still have to learn	How we find out
Will people pay?	Income per person	Spend on learning apps	Paid test: install-to-paid rate
Who do we beat?	Not covered	Top apps and their prices	App-store rankings
Can they pay us?	Not covered	Card, e-wallet, carrier billing	Payment-provider reports
What does a user cost?	Not covered	Cost per paying subscriber	Paid test in both markets
Can we operate?	Not covered	Data and local-entity rules	Legal review

A six-week paid test in Indonesia and Vietnam answers those questions before full spend

Paid market test, six weeks



Approve the paid test now, and launch in Indonesia if acquisition cost meets our payback target

		Owner	Timing
1	Approve a six-week paid test in Indonesia and Vietnam Same budget and creative in both; test budget set by Finance	CEO	This month
2	Set the payback target for a new market The go/no-go rule for the test, agreed before it starts	CFO	Before test
3	Check data-protection and local-entity rules Indonesia and Vietnam, for a consumer subscription app	Legal	Week 4
4	Decide go or no-go on Indonesia Vietnam is next if Indonesia misses the target	CEO and CFO	Week 6

Indicator table for the four markets, latest World Bank data

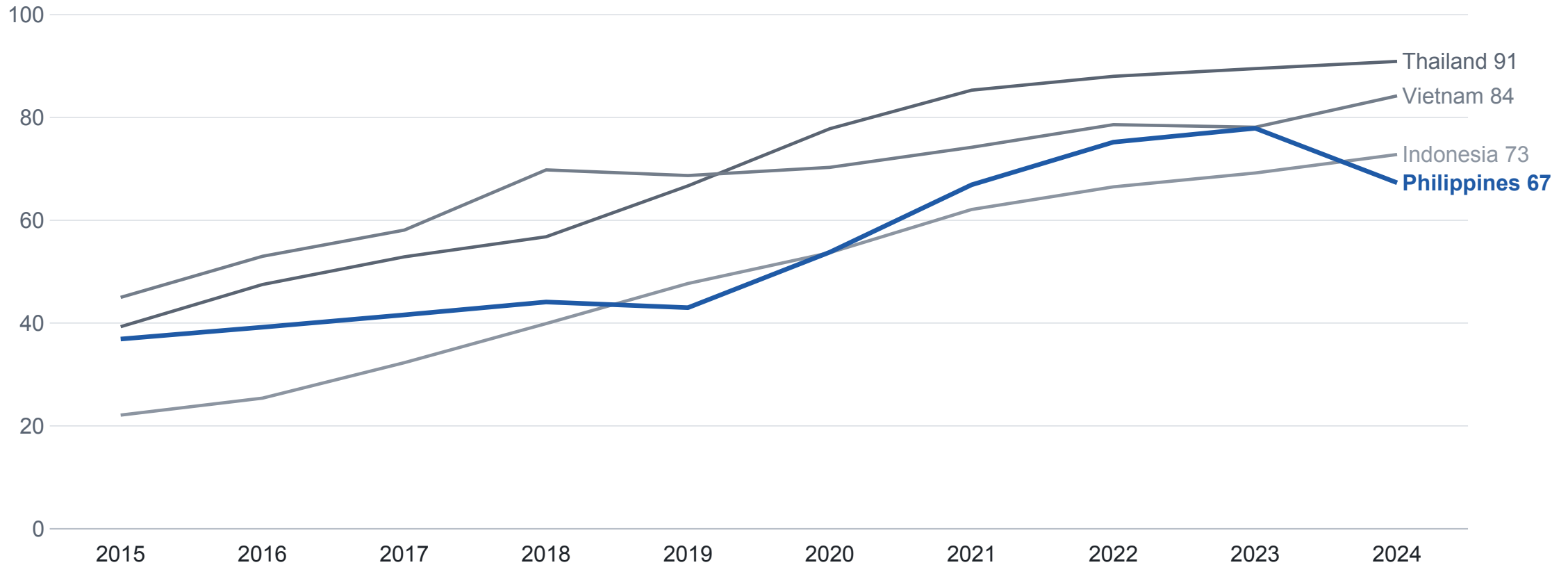
Indicator	Indonesia	Vietnam	Philippines	Thailand
Population 2024, M	283.5	101.0	115.8	71.7
Internet use 2024, %	72.8	84.2	67.3	90.9
Internet users 2024, M	206.3	85.0	77.9	65.1
GDP per capita PPP 2024, \$	16,472	16,388	11,814	24,909
GDP growth 2025, %	5.1	8.0	4.4	2.4
Avg GDP growth 2021-25, %	4.8	6.2	5.8	2.4
Income growth 2019-25, %	47.3	64.0	40.9	31.5
Ages 15-64 2025, % of total	68.2	67.7	67.1	69.6
Mobile subscriptions per 100, 2024	122.5	127.6	115.3	160.6

Working-age share and mobile subscriptions do not separate the four markets, so the main slides leave them out.

Source: World Bank WDI (SP.POP.TOTL, IT.NET.USER.ZS, NY.GDP.PCAP.PP.CD, NY.GDP.MKTP.KD.ZG, SP.POP.1564.TO.ZS, IT.CEL.SETS.P2), last updated 2026-07-13.

The Philippines' internet-use rate fell 10.6 points in 2024, so treat its online count with caution

Individuals using the internet, % of population



On 2023 data the Philippines had about 89M users (114.9M x 77.9%), still well below Indonesia. This deck does not explain the 2024 drop; check the series notes before using it.
Source: World Bank WDI, individuals using the internet (% of population) (IT.NET.USER.ZS), 2015-2024.